

ferings and offerings from the consumer market—a far less suitable solution for demanding environments.

What top technologies do you see critical to the future of SFF and why?

Nothing can stop the trend towards SFF designs. The only question is, which technology will lead in the long term? Making the right decision on this matter today is critical for many OEMs. Since we do not want to rely on the success of only one specific chip maker, we support all relevant technologies used in this area starting with x86 technologies and extending it towards ARM technologies.

What are the issues to be tackled?

As the embedded computer market establishes with reliable embedded form factors from different vendors, the market for RISC-based SFF devices needs to be standardised as well because embedded OEMs need long-term stable platforms to facilitate these technologies.

How active is Kontron in the SFF space?

In terms of x86 technologies, Kontron has been the leading company in the SFF sector. An example of this is that Kontron specified the world's leading *de-facto* standard ETX and has also been the main force behind the COM Express standard. Complementary to this, Kontron has now specified a new standard for SFF ARM modules. Kontron also

specified and launched the world's first vendor-independent credit card-sized module specification named DIMM-PC for ISA-based system designs.

What do you offer in India?

Kontron offers an entire range of embedded computer technologies to Indian customers. We help our customers to design their embedded appliances based on standard platforms as well as customised solutions. Kontron Technology India (KTI) focuses on helping OEMs in vertical markets such as energy production, transportation and distribution, healthcare and communications. The company delivers embedded computer products with competent local technical support to provide stable long-term deliveries. Also, many of Kontron's global customers are moving more and more of their R&D activities into India. Thus, KTI is focusing on supporting these international OEMs.

How different are the market requirements in India and how do you meet these?

Embedded computer technology is a global market. We do not see any major difference in the local market here in terms of hardware requirements. As for software development skills, this goes hand in hand with our hardware offerings because we enable developers to start with software integration by providing them with sophisticated board support packages and drivers for the most relevant operating systems. ●

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